

Last Word — Complete Setup Guide

From zero to live in under 2 hours

Your file structure

```
last-word/
├── api/
│   ├── create-checkout.js    ← Creates Stripe sessions (called by frontend)
│   ├── stripe-webhook.js    ← Receives Stripe events, fires email
│   └── _email-template.js    ← HTML email template
├── src/
│   └── App.jsx               ← last-word-pro.jsx (rename and move here)
├── package.json
└── .env.local
```

Step 1 — Install dependencies

```
npm create vite@latest last-word -- --template react
cd last-word
npm install stripe resend
```

Copy your three files into the structure above.

Step 2 — Environment variables

Create `.env.local` in your project root:

```
# Stripe
STRIPE_SECRET_KEY=sk_live_...
STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET=whsec_...
NEXT_PUBLIC_BASE_URL=https://lastword.co.uk
```

```
# Resend
RESEND_API_KEY=re_...
FROM_EMAIL=Last Word <letters@lastword.co.uk>
```

Add these same variables in: **Vercel Dashboard → Your Project → Settings → Environment Variables**

Step 3 — Stripe setup (15 minutes)

A. Create your products

1. Go to **dashboard.stripe.com → Products → Add product**
2. Create three products:
 - Essential — £15 one-time
 - Premium — £35 one-time
 - Legacy Vault — £49 one-time
3. Copy each `price_xxx` ID into `api/create-checkout.js` → `PRICE_IDS`

B. Set up the webhook

1. Go to **Stripe → Developers → Webhooks → Add endpoint**
2. URL: `https://lastword.co.uk/api/stripe-webhook`
3. Select event: `checkout.session.completed`
4. Copy the **Signing secret** (`whsec_...`) → paste into env as `STRIPE_WEBHOOK_SECRET`

C. Test locally with Stripe CLI

```
npm install -g stripe
stripe login
stripe listen --forward-to localhost:3000/api/stripe-webhook
# In another terminal:
stripe trigger checkout.session.completed
```

Step 4 — Resend setup (10 minutes)

1. Sign up at **resend.com** (free tier: 3,000 emails/month)
 2. Go to **Domains → Add domain** → add `lastword.co.uk`
 3. Add the DNS records Resend gives you to your domain registrar
 4. Go to **API Keys → Create API Key** → copy into env as `RESEND_API_KEY`
 5. Set `FROM_EMAIL=Last Word <letters@lastword.co.uk>`
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Step 5 — Update the frontend

In `last-word-pro.jsx`, replace the `handleStripeCheckout` function:

```
async function handleStripeCheckout() {
  const pkg = PACKAGES.find(p => p.id === selectedPackage);
  if (!pkg || !email) return;

  setStep("checkout"); // show loading state

  const res = await fetch("/api/create-checkout", {
    method: "POST",
    headers: { "Content-Type": "application/json" },
    body: JSON.stringify({
      email,
      packageId: selectedPackage,
      packageName: pkg.label,
      letter: letter,
      occasionLabel: occasion?.label,
      toneLabel: TONES.find(t => t.id === tone)?.label,
    }),
  });

  const data = await res.json();
  if (data.url) {
    window.location.href = data.url; // redirect to Stripe Checkout
  }
}
```

Step 6 — Deploy to Vercel (5 minutes)

```
npm install -g vercel
```

```
vercel login
vercel --prod
```

Or connect your GitHub repo at **vercel.com** → **New Project** for auto-deploys.

Step 7 — Buy your domain

1. Go to **namecheap.com** → search `lastword.co.uk` (~£10/year)
 2. In Vercel → your project → **Settings** → **Domains** → add `lastword.co.uk`
 3. Follow Vercel's DNS instructions (takes ~10 minutes to propagate)
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Important note on letter storage

Stripe metadata has a 500-character limit per value. For longer letters, the recommended production approach is:

1. Save the letter to a database (e.g. **Supabase** free tier) when generated
2. Store only the `record_id` in Stripe metadata
3. In the webhook, fetch the full letter from the database using the ID

This is a 30-minute addition once your MVP is live and earning.

Revenue at a glance

Package	Price	Your take (after Stripe 1.4% + 20p)
Essential	£15	~£14.59
Premium	£35	~£34.31
Legacy Vault	£49	~£48.02

Break-even: Your first sale covers a full year of hosting and domain costs.

You're live. Now what?

The best early marketing for a word-of-mouth business:

- **Reddit:** Post in r/relationship_advice, r/weddingplanning, r/EstrangedAdultChildren — genuinely helpful comments mentioning your service
- **Facebook Groups:** Bereavement groups, reconciliation groups — people who *need* this today
- **One tweet:** "I built a thing for the letters you've been putting off for years" — that's it

Good luck. The business is real. The need is real.